MJC 08: British Literature: 18th Century

Unit 1: Historical Overview of the Period

- **1.1 Historical and Political Background**
  - 1.1.1 Restoration Period
  - 1.1.2 Glorious Revolution
- **1.2 Literary and Intellectual Movements**
  - 1.2.1 New Classicism (Neo-Classicism)
  - 1.2.2 The Enlightenment

Unit 2: Jonathan Swift — *Gulliver's Travels*

- **2.1 Author and Text Introduction**
  - 2.1.1 Life and times of Jonathan Swift
  - 2.1.2 Concept of satire and background of *Gulliver's Travels*
- **2.2 Textual Analysis**
  - 2.2.1 Major themes, key characters, and political satire
  - 2.2.2 Critique of human nature and contemporary society

Unit 3: Daniel Defoe — *Robinson Crusoe*

- **3.1 Author and Text Introduction**
  - 3.1.1 Daniel Defoe and the rise of the modern English novel
  - 3.1.2 Historical and social context of *Robinson Crusoe*
- **3.2 Textual Analysis**
  - 3.2.1 Realism, individualism, and colonial themes
  - 3.2.2 Plot development, characterization, and the struggle for survival

Unit 4: Thomas Gray — *'Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard'*

- **4.1 Poet and Poem Introduction**
  - 4.1.1 Thomas Gray and the Graveyard School of Poetry
  - 4.1.2 Understanding the literary genre of an elegy
- **4.2 Poetic Analysis**
  - 4.2.1 Major themes: Mortality, the unsung lives of the poor, and death as the ultimate equalizer
  - 4.2.2 Poetic structure, imagery, and symbolism